

PATTERN

Crochet Santa Hat Pattern

A classic red-and-white Santa hat, worked in the round from the crown down, finished with a soft pom-pom.

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This hat starts at the crown with a magic ring, increases into a circle, then switches to straight rounds worked in the back loop only for a slight ribbed texture, before angling into the classic Santa-hat point at the top back. If you're new to starting from a ring, our [magic ring tutorial](#) covers it step by step.

What you need

- Worsted weight (#4) yarn: red (main) and white (cuff and pom-pom), about 120 yards total for an adult size
- 5.0mm (US H/8) hook
- Stitch marker
- Pom-pom maker or a piece of cardboard, or a store-bought faux-fur pom-pom
- Yarn needle

Crown

Steps

1. Magic ring, 6 sc into the ring. (6 sts)
2. Round 2: 2 sc in each st around. (12 sts)
3. Round 3: *sc, 2 sc in next st* around. (18 sts)
4. Round 4: *2 sc, 2 sc in next st* around. (24 sts)
5. Continue increasing by 6 sts each round, working one more plain stitch between increases each time, until the circle measures the head circumference you're making for (roughly rounds 8–9 for an average adult head, using 42–48 sts).

Body of the hat

Once the crown circle is wide enough, stop increasing and work straight rounds of sc (or hdc for a slightly looser, quicker fabric) until the hat measures about 8–9 inches from the top of the crown for an adult, or 5–6 inches for a child.

Shaping the point

Steps

1. To create the classic Santa-hat flop, decrease only along one side (the back) rather than evenly around: work 2–3 plain rounds, then sc2tog every 4–5 stitches along roughly a third of the round at the back for several rounds in a row.
2. This pulls that section in faster than the rest, curling the top toward the back. Continue until the point is 4–5 inches long, then fasten off.

Cuff and pom-pom

Steps

1. Join white yarn at the bottom edge. Work 4–5 rounds of hdc in the back loop only for a ribbed look, or plain hdc for a smoother cuff.
2. Fasten off and fold the cuff up to the outside of the hat.
3. Make a pom-pom about 2.5–3 inches across and attach it firmly to the tip of the point.

Frequently asked questions

How do I size this for a child?

Reduce the crown increases to about 30–36 sts total before switching to straight rounds, and shorten the body to 5–6 inches before shaping the point.

Can I skip the pom-pom?

Yes — a simple folded point without a pom-pom still reads clearly as a Santa hat, especially in red and white.

What if my hat is too tight?

Add one more increase round at the crown before switching to straight rounds, which adds roughly 6 stitches of circumference.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.